

● ELITE PLAN · \$34.99 CAD/MONTH

NO EQUIPMENT · 15 TO 30 MIN

# 10 HIIT ROUTINES

Maximum metabolic stimulus in the minimum time, with the exact structure needed **not** to sacrifice the muscle you have built.

10 COMPLETE ROUTINES

NO EQUIPMENT

8-WEEK PROGRESSION

3 LEVELS



10

ROUTINES

15-30

MINUTES PER  
SESSION

3

SCALING LEVELS

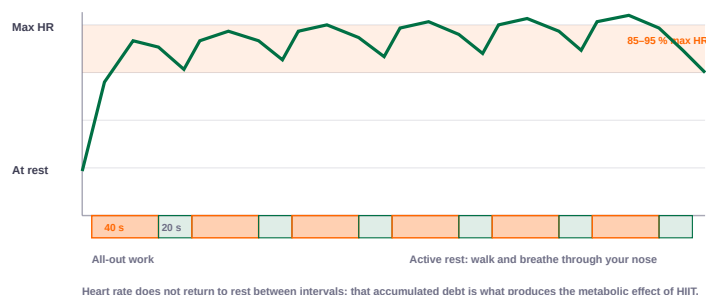
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## BEFORE THE FIRST ROUND

HIIT is powerful, and that is exactly why it is easy to overdose: done well it burns fat and raises your work capacity; done badly it steals the recovery your lifting depends on.

FIG. 1 INTERVALS AND HEART RATE



The orange blocks are all-out work and the blue ones active rest. Notice that the heart-rate curve **never comes all the way down** between intervals.

## THE FIVE RULES OF INTELLIGENT HIIT

### 01 Never the day before leg day

Nor the day right after. HIIT competes directly with your lower-body session for the same resources.

### 02 Always warm up for 5 minutes

Hip and ankle mobility, 20 jumping jacks, 10 bodyweight squats and 10 shoulder rotations. It is not optional.

### 03 The interval is all-out or it is not HIIT

If you can hold a conversation during the work phase, you are doing moderate cardio under a fancier name.

### 04 Rest is part of the training too

Breathe through your nose and keep walking. Cutting it short does not make the session more effective, only worse executed.

### 05 Log your rounds and reps

Progressing in HIIT means doing more work in the same time, not simply finishing wrecked.

## WHEN NOT TO DO HIIT

- You have slept less than 6 hours, or you are coming off three bad nights in a row.
- You have severe muscle soreness that alters your technique.
- You are in the final week of an aggressive calorie deficit and your strength is dropping.
- You feel joint discomfort in a knee, an ankle, a shoulder or your lower back.

### WARNING SIGN: STOP IMMEDIATELY

Chest pain, dizziness, blurred vision, severe nausea or breathlessness out of all proportion to the effort. Stop the session, sit down and seek medical attention if it does not pass within a few minutes.

## 01 · CLASSIC TABATA — 20 MIN

The most studied HIIT protocol there is. Four blocks of 8 rounds, with 1 minute of rest between blocks.

MEDIUM LEVEL

| EXERCISE          | WORK | REST | ROUNDS | MAIN MUSCLE     |
|-------------------|------|------|--------|-----------------|
| Burpees           | 20 s | 10 s | 8      | Full body       |
| Star jumps        | 20 s | 10 s | 8      | Cardio and legs |
| Mountain climbers | 20 s | 10 s | 8      | Core and cardio |
| Jump squats       | 20 s | 10 s | 8      | Legs and glutes |

## 02 · HIIT 40/20 — 24 MIN

More time under work to accumulate volume. The best option when the main goal is calorie expenditure.

HIGH LEVEL

| EXERCISE           | WORK | REST | ROUNDS | MAIN MUSCLE       |
|--------------------|------|------|--------|-------------------|
| Sprints in place   | 40 s | 20 s | 6      | Whole-body cardio |
| Jump lunges        | 40 s | 20 s | 6      | Legs              |
| Explosive push-ups | 40 s | 20 s | 6      | Chest and triceps |
| High knees         | 40 s | 20 s | 6      | Cardio and core   |

### HOW TO RUN THE ROUTINE

In these two routines you complete **every round of one exercise** before moving on to the next. That is what produces the lactate build-up characteristic of the original Tabata.

## 03 · EMOM — 20 MIN

**Every Minute On the Minute:** perform the prescribed reps and rest for whatever is left of the minute. The faster you work, the longer you rest. **MEDIUM LEVEL**

| BLOCK         | WORK PER MINUTE      | MINUTES | MAIN MUSCLE |
|---------------|----------------------|---------|-------------|
| Minutes 1-5   | 15 burpees           | 5       | Full body   |
| Minutes 6-10  | 20 jump squats       | 5       | Legs        |
| Minutes 11-15 | 12 push-ups          | 5       | Upper body  |
| Minutes 16-20 | 20 mountain climbers | 5       | Core        |

## 04 · FULL BODY FURY — 25 MIN

Full-body circuit: 30 s of work and 15 s of transition, 5 circuits with 1 minute of rest between circuits. **HIGH LEVEL**

| EXERCISE                | WORK | REST | CIRCUITS | MAIN MUSCLE        |
|-------------------------|------|------|----------|--------------------|
| Full burpee             | 30 s | 15 s | 5        | Full body          |
| Jump squat              | 30 s | 15 s | 5        | Quads and glutes   |
| Push-ups                | 30 s | 15 s | 5        | Chest and triceps  |
| Alternating lunges      | 30 s | 15 s | 5        | Legs and glutes    |
| Plank with shoulder tap | 30 s | 15 s | 5        | Core and stability |

### COUNT YOUR REPS ON CIRCUIT 1

Write them down and try to match them on circuit 5. Losing more than 30 % of your reps between the first circuit and the last means you went out too hard: pace yourself better next time.

## 05 · LOWER BODY INFERNO — 22 MIN

40 s of work and 20 s of rest, 4 circuits. Specific lower-body work: place it well away from your leg day.

**HIGH LEVEL**

| EXERCISE                          | WORK | REST | CIRCUITS | MAIN MUSCLE              |
|-----------------------------------|------|------|----------|--------------------------|
| Box or step jump                  | 40 s | 20 s | 4        | Quad power               |
| Sumo squat                        | 40 s | 20 s | 4        | Adductors and glutes     |
| Wall sit                          | 40 s | 20 s | 4        | Quads (isometric)        |
| Alternating Bulgarian split squat | 40 s | 20 s | 4        | Single-leg glute         |
| Calf raises with a hop            | 40 s | 20 s | 4        | Gastrocnemius and soleus |

## 06 · UPPER BODY BLAST — 20 MIN

35 s of work and 15 s of rest, 5 circuits. Ideal as a finisher after a light upper-body session.

**MEDIUM LEVEL**

| EXERCISE                 | WORK | REST | CIRCUITS | MAIN MUSCLE             |
|--------------------------|------|------|----------|-------------------------|
| Standard push-ups        | 35 s | 15 s | 5        | Chest                   |
| Dips on a bench or chair | 35 s | 15 s | 5        | Triceps                 |
| Diamond push-ups         | 35 s | 15 s | 5        | Triceps and inner chest |
| Pike push-ups            | 35 s | 15 s | 5        | Shoulder                |

### SCALING THE PUSH-UPS

If you cannot complete 8 clean reps, drop to your knees or raise your hands onto a bench. Lowering the demand while keeping the full range is always better than half-reps with a sagging hip.

## 07 · CORE DESTROYER — 18 MIN

30 s of work and 10 s of rest, 6 circuits. The shortest routine, and the one that pairs best with any other.

**MEDIUM LEVEL**

| EXERCISE         | WORK | REST | CIRCUITS | MAIN MUSCLE                   |
|------------------|------|------|----------|-------------------------------|
| Front plank      | 30 s | 10 s | 6        | Anterior core                 |
| Russian twists   | 30 s | 10 s | 6        | Obliques                      |
| Bicycle crunches | 30 s | 10 s | 6        | Rectus abdominis and obliques |
| V-sit            | 30 s | 10 s | 6        | Full core                     |

## 08 · CARDIO KING — 30 MIN

45 s of work and 15 s of rest, 4 circuits with 1 minute between circuits. The highest calorie-burn session in this document.

**HIGH LEVEL**

| EXERCISE                                       | WORK | REST | CIRCUITS | MAIN MUSCLE             |
|------------------------------------------------|------|------|----------|-------------------------|
| Sprint in place                                | 45 s | 15 s | 4        | Whole-body cardio       |
| Jump rope, or the same movement without a rope | 45 s | 15 s | 4        | Calves and coordination |
| High knees                                     | 45 s | 15 s | 4        | Hip flexors             |
| Lateral skaters                                | 45 s | 15 s | 4        | Gluteus medius          |
| Burpee without the push-up                     | 45 s | 15 s | 4        | Full body               |
| Jumping jacks                                  | 45 s | 15 s | 4        | Cardio                  |

### CARDIO KING IS NOT A WEEKLY ROUTINE

Use it **once every two weeks** at most. Thirty minutes at this intensity create a central fatigue you will feel in the gym for two days.

## 09 · METABOLIC CIRCUIT — 28 MIN

Five 4-minute AMRAP blocks (as many rounds as possible), with 2 minutes of rest between blocks.

**ADVANCED LEVEL**

| BLOCK   | SEQUENCE (REPEAT FOR 4 MIN)                    | ROUNDS COMPLETED |
|---------|------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Block 1 | 8 burpees + 12 jump squats                     | _____            |
| Block 2 | 10 push-ups + 15 mountain climbers per side    | _____            |
| Block 3 | 12 alternating lunges + 10 box jumps           | _____            |
| Block 4 | 15 jumping jacks + 10 V-sits + 20 s of plank   | _____            |
| Block 5 | 8 burpees + 8 diamond push-ups + 20 high knees | _____            |

## 10 · FINISHER EXPRESS — 15 MIN

Eight exercises in Tabata format (20 s / 10 s), three full circuits with 1 minute between circuits. The workout you never feel like doing.

**MAXIMUM LEVEL**

| ORDER | EXERCISE          | ORDER | EXERCISE        |
|-------|-------------------|-------|-----------------|
| 1     | Burpees           | 5     | Jump lunges     |
| 2     | Jump squats       | 6     | Russian twists  |
| 3     | Push-ups          | 7     | Lateral skaters |
| 4     | Mountain climbers | 8     | Active plank    |

### HOW TO SCORE YOUR SESSION

In AMRAP routines your score is the **total number of rounds**. Write it down and compare it every four weeks on the same routine: it is the cleanest way to confirm that your conditioning really is improving.

## 8-WEEK PROGRESSION

| WEEK          | SESSIONS | RECOMMENDED ROUTINES                               | TARGET                                      |
|---------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>Week 1</b> | 2        | 07 Core Destroyer · 03 EMOM                        | Learn the formats without wrecking yourself |
| <b>Week 2</b> | 2        | 01 Tabata · 06 Upper Body Blast                    | Introduce pure interval work                |
| <b>Week 3</b> | 3        | 01 Tabata · 04 Full Body Fury · 07 Core            | Raise the frequency                         |
| <b>Week 4</b> | 2        | 03 EMOM · 07 Core Destroyer                        | Deload: less volume, same intensity         |
| <b>Week 5</b> | 3        | 02 HIIT 40/20 · 05 Lower Inferno · 06 Upper        | Work by specific muscle groups              |
| <b>Week 6</b> | 3        | 02 HIIT 40/20 · 04 Full Body Fury · 08 Cardio King | Highest calorie burn of the block           |
| <b>Week 7</b> | 4        | 09 Metabolic · 05 Lower · 06 Upper · 07 Core       | Volume peak                                 |
| <b>Week 8</b> | 3        | 10 Finisher Express · 01 Tabata · 07 Core          | Final test and deload                       |

## SCALING TO YOUR LEVEL

| VARIABLE               | BEGINNER                     | INTERMEDIATE    | ADVANCED                    |
|------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>Work/rest ratio</b> | 20 s / 40 s                  | 30 s / 30 s     | 40 s / 20 s                 |
| <b>Circuits</b>        | Half of those prescribed     | As prescribed   | As prescribed + 1           |
| <b>Burpees</b>         | No jump, no push-up          | Full            | With a knees-to-chest jump  |
| <b>Push-ups</b>        | On your knees                | Standard        | Explosive, or with a clap   |
| <b>Jump squat</b>      | Bodyweight squat             | With a jump     | With a jump and a 180° turn |
| <b>Joint impact</b>    | Replace the jumps with steps | Controlled jump | Full plyometric jump        |

## YOUR SESSION LOG

| DATE | ROUTINE | ROUNDS OR REPS | RPE (1-10) | HOW IT FELT |
|------|---------|----------------|------------|-------------|
|      |         |                |            |             |
|      |         |                |            |             |
|      |         |                |            |             |
|      |         |                |            |             |
|      |         |                |            |             |



## WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

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| WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR     | WHAT YOU WILL FIND                                                           | WHERE                                                     |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Reference intakes            | RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral       | <a href="https://ods.od.nih.gov">ods.od.nih.gov</a>       |
| Food composition             | The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient                           | <a href="https://fdc.nal.usda.gov">fdc.nal.usda.gov</a>   |
| Dietary guidelines           | Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium       | <a href="https://health.gov">health.gov</a>               |
| Physical activity guidelines | The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement             | <a href="https://health.gov">health.gov</a>               |
| Physical readiness doctrine  | FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness                     | <a href="https://armypubs.army.mil">armypubs.army.mil</a> |
| Lifting equation             | How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation             | <a href="https://cdc.gov/niosh">cdc.gov/niosh</a>         |
| Food safety                  | Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone                               | <a href="https://foodsafety.gov">foodsafety.gov</a>       |
| Health claims                | What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused | European Commission register                              |

### HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

### REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

## TECHNIQUE FOR THE KEY MOVEMENTS

| EXERCISE                 | CORRECT EXECUTION                                                                    | THE MISTAKE THAT CAUSES INJURY                                   |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Burpee</b>            | Hands to the floor, controlled jump back, chest down, jump forward and vertical jump | Letting the hip drop on the way down (lumbar hyperextension)     |
| <b>Jump squat</b>        | Land on the ball of the foot first and absorb by bending knee and hip                | Landing with a stiff leg and the knee caving inwards             |
| <b>Mountain climbers</b> | Hip low and stable, shoulders over the wrists                                        | Raising the hip and bouncing off the feet                        |
| <b>Jump lunge</b>        | Torso vertical, rear knee towards the floor without touching it                      | Front knee travelling far beyond the toes                        |
| <b>Push-up</b>           | Body in a straight line, elbows at 45°, chest to the floor                           | Elbows flared to 90° and hip sagging                             |
| <b>Plank</b>             | Glutes and abs engaged, hip neutral, eyes on the floor                               | Hip too high or sagging, neck in extension                       |
| <b>Box jump</b>          | Jump up, step down                                                                   | Jumping back down: it multiplies the load on the patellar tendon |

### TECHNIQUE BREAKS BEFORE THE MUSCLE DOES

In the last 10 seconds of every interval, fatigue degrades execution. If you feel your position going, **stop and end the interval**. A badly done burpee does not add work, it adds risk.

## HIIT IS ONLY ONE PIECE

HIIT pays off when it is **not the only thing you do**: two sessions a week at most, never on consecutive days, and always on a base of strength work, enough food and sleep. On its own it turns into wear and tear.

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